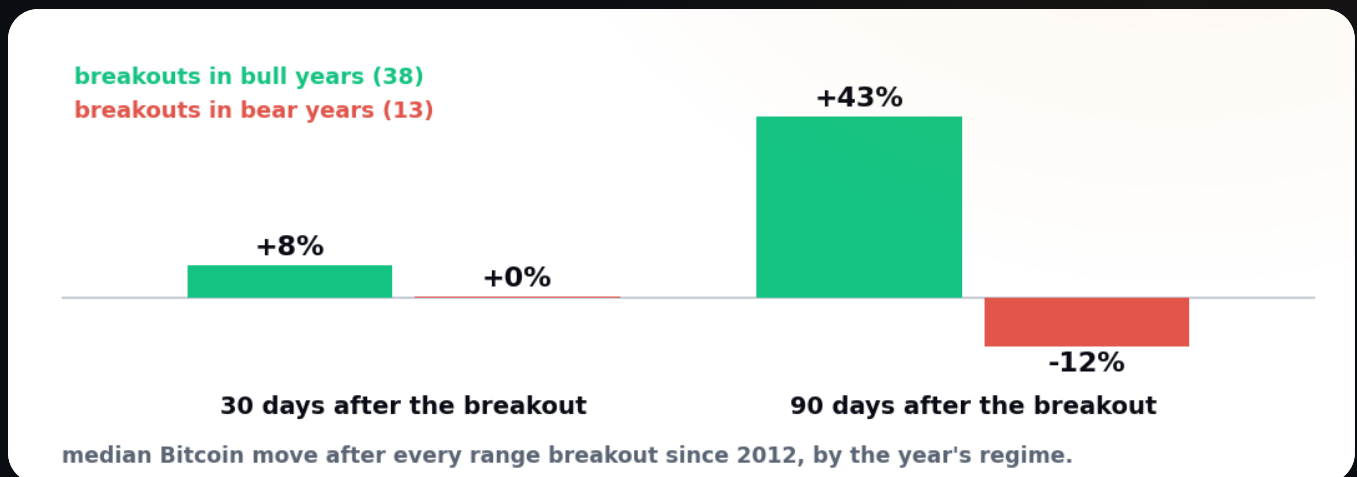


THE BREAKOUT STUDY

On 21 September 2026 Bitcoin closed out of a 30-day range and two days later was already pulling back toward it. Every range breakout on Bitcoin since 2012, graded.

How often a breakout comes back to test the level, whether losing it in the first week means anything, and why the year mattered more than the breakout.



51

range breakouts since 2012

60%

of the ones that ran 3%+
came back to test the level

85%

of bear-year breakouts lost
the level inside a month

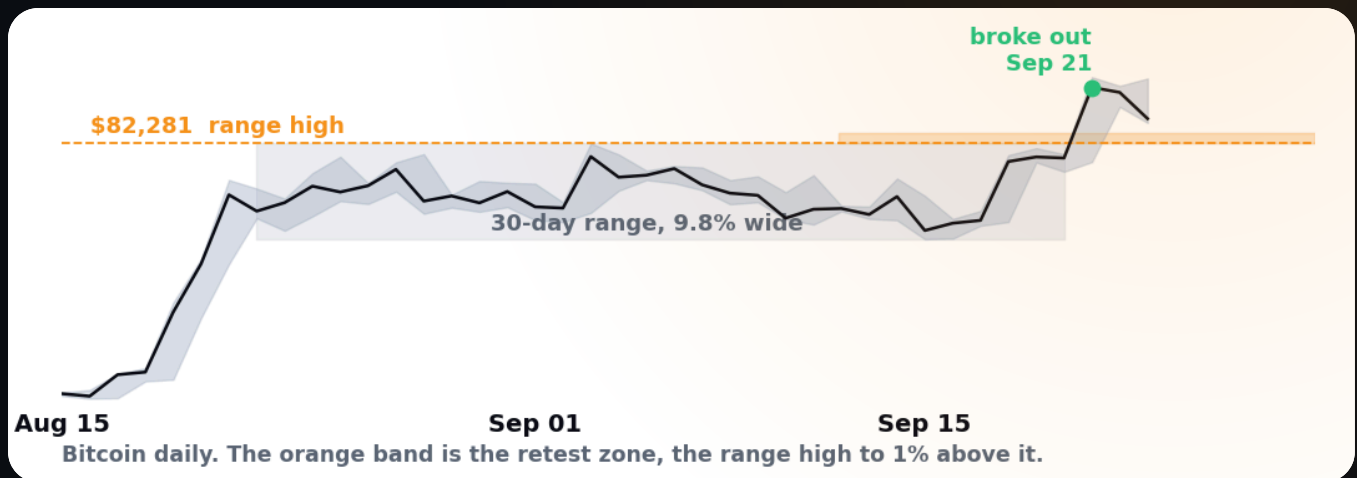
Educational, not financial advice. One fixed rule applied to fifteen years of daily candles. The rule is on the next page, and the week-one test uses nothing that happened after day seven.



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THE RULE

WHAT A RANGE IS, AND WHAT A **BREAKOUT** IS



Range. The last 30 daily candles. The range high is the highest wick, the range low the lowest. It only counts as a range if the high sits within 25% of the low, so a trending month does not qualify. **Breakout.** The first daily close above the range high. One breakout per 30 days, so a single move is not counted twice. Data is Bitstamp BTC/USD daily from 2012.

The grades. The close 7, 30 and 90 days after the breakout, against the same horizons from every day since 2012. **Retest.** After the breakout has run at least 3% above the level, a later wick back to within 1% of it inside 30 days. **Lost the level.** Any daily close back under the range high inside 30 days. **Regime.** Bull years 2012, 2013, 2016, 2017, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2023, 2024 and 2025. Bear years 2014, 2015, 2018, 2022 and 2026.

ROBUSTNESS

Tightening the rule to ranges 15% wide or less leaves 27 breakouts. The shape is the same, bull years +54% at 90 days, and 86% of bear-year breakouts lost the level.

THE SCOREBOARD

BREAKOUTS AGAINST ANY DAY

GROUP	N	+7D	+30D / HIGHER	+90D / HIGHER	LOST THE LEVEL IN 30D
all breakouts	51	+0.5%	+6.1% / 63%	+25.6% / 65%	67%
bull years	38	+0.7%	+7.9% / 66%	+43.5% / 76%	61%
bear years	13	-2.5%	+0.4% / 54%	-11.9% / 27%	85%
any day	5,349	+0.8%	+3.0% / 57%	+9.7% / 59%	

Medians. 'higher' = share of breakouts with a higher close.

Across all 51 breakouts, Bitcoin was a median +26% ninety days later, higher 65% of the time, against +10% for any random 90 days. Buying a range breakout did beat a random day on average. The average hides a split that matters more than the breakout itself.

In bull years the breakouts were +43% ninety days later and higher 76% of the time. In bear years they were -12% and higher only 27% of the time, and 85% of them lost the level inside a month. Same shape on the chart, opposite result.

THE RETEST

MOST BREAKOUTS COME BACK

Of the 45 breakouts that ran at least 3% above the level inside a month, 27 came back to within 1% of it, 60%. The median retest came 4 days after the breakout. Across all 51 breakouts, 67% closed back under the level at least once inside 30 days. The typical worst dip inside that month was -5%.

That makes a pullback to the level the normal path, not the failure case. A breakout that runs straight up without ever looking back is the minority.

WEEK ONE, GRADED FROM DAY 7	N	NEXT 23 DAYS / HIGHER	NEXT 83 DAYS / HIGHER
all, held every close in week 1	25	+3.3% / 60%	+24.6% / 64%
all, closed back under in week 1	24	+3.2% / 62%	+16.0% / 67%
bull years, held week 1	21	+3.7% / 62%	+38.4% / 76%
bull years, lost it in week 1	17	+2.2% / 65%	+47.2% / 76%
bear years, held week 1	4	-7.3% / 50%	-16.6% / 0%
bear years, lost it in week 1	7	+4.3% / 57%	-7.3% / 43%

Groups are sorted only on the first seven days, and returns are measured from day 7, so nothing later leaks into the sort.

Losing the level in the first week told you nothing. In bull years the breakouts that closed back under in week one did as well as, or better than, the ones that held every close. In bear years both groups were weak. The first week was noise and the year decided it.

EVERY BREAKOUT

ALL 52 BREAKOUTS, 2012 TO 2026

BREAKOUT	RANGE HIGH	RANGE WIDTH	CLOSE ABOVE	+30D	+90D	LOST LEVEL 30D	YEAR
20 Apr 2012	\$5.00	14%	+3.9%	-7%	+63%	yes	bull
31 May 2012	\$5.00	6%	+0.4%	+28%	+109%	no	bull
07 Jul 2012	\$7.00	24%	+1.5%	+60%	+84%	no	bull
22 Nov 2012	\$12.00	23%	+1.5%	+11%	+153%	no	bull
10 Jan 2013	\$14.00	9%	+0.4%	+65%	+1057%	yes	bull
19 Aug 2013	\$101	23%	+1.8%	+23%	+364%	no	bull
22 May 2014	\$505	20%	+4.9%	+12%	-3%	no	bear
16 Jun 2015	\$242	10%	+3.5%	+11%	-8%	yes	bear
06 Oct 2015	\$246	10%	+0.1%	+56%	+76%	yes	bear
20 Feb 2016	\$425	17%	+2.3%	-5%	+2%	yes	bull
15 Apr 2016	\$428	6%	+0.3%	+7%	+53%	yes	bull
27 May 2016	\$469	8%	+0.6%	+33%	+22%	no	bull
04 Sep 2016	\$603	9%	+0.1%	+1%	+26%	yes	bull
11 Oct 2016	\$629	6%	+1.6%	+12%	+40%	yes	bull
02 Dec 2016	\$755	13%	+2.0%	+30%	+63%	yes	bull
20 Feb 2017	\$1,075	22%	+0.9%	-4%	+86%	yes	bull
17 Jul 2018	\$6,842	18%	+6.9%	-14%	-12%	yes	bear
04 Sep 2018	\$7,340	25%	+0.3%	-11%	-48%	yes	bear
18 Feb 2019	\$3,774	14%	+2.5%	+4%	+112%	yes	bull
29 Mar 2019	\$4,055	11%	+0.9%	+26%	+173%	no	bull
03 May 2019	\$5,627	18%	+0.6%	+54%	+84%	no	bull
26 Oct 2019	\$8,820	21%	+4.9%	-23%	-9%	yes	bull
06 Jan 2020	\$7,693	20%	+0.9%	+24%	-13%	no	bull
01 Jun 2020	\$10,074	24%	+1.3%	-10%	+15%	yes	bull
25 Jul 2020	\$9,690	10%	+0.2%	+21%	+33%	no	bull
10 Oct 2020	\$11,183	10%	+1.1%	+36%	+260%	no	bull

Close above = how far the breakout day closed above the range high.

EVERY BREAKOUT

ALL 52 BREAKOUTS, CONTINUED

BREAKOUT	RANGE HIGH	RANGE WIDTH	CLOSE ABOVE	+30D	+90D	LOST LEVEL 30D	YEAR
13 Apr 2021	\$61,700	22%	+3.0%	-22%	-48%	yes	bull
06 Sep 2021	\$51,900	23%	+1.6%	+5%	-6%	yes	bull
27 Mar 2022	\$45,332	22%	+3.4%	-19%	-54%	yes	bear
26 Oct 2022	\$20,469	13%	+1.5%	-21%	+9%	yes	bear
13 Dec 2022	\$17,418	12%	+2.0%	+6%	+36%	yes	bear
12 Jan 2023	\$18,373	13%	+2.6%	+16%	+59%	no	bull
15 Feb 2023	\$24,258	19%	+0.3%	+13%	+11%	yes	bull
21 Jun 2023	\$28,452	15%	+5.5%	-0%	-9%	no	bull
01 Oct 2023	\$27,486	10%	+1.9%	+24%	+51%	yes	bull
01 Dec 2023	\$38,457	13%	+0.7%	+9%	+58%	no	bull
02 Jan 2024	\$44,729	14%	+0.5%	-4%	+55%	yes	bull
20 May 2024	\$67,654	20%	+5.5%	-9%	-18%	yes	bull
19 Jul 2024	\$66,455	24%	+0.4%	-12%	+1%	yes	bull
26 Sep 2024	\$64,795	23%	+0.6%	+3%	+52%	yes	bull
28 Oct 2024	\$69,487	18%	+0.6%	+37%	+47%	yes	bull
15 Dec 2024	\$103,647	19%	+0.8%	-8%	-19%	yes	bull
22 Apr 2025	\$88,772	19%	+5.3%	+20%	+26%	no	bull
09 Jul 2025	\$110,587	13%	+0.6%	+5%	+9%	no	bull
13 Aug 2025	\$123,236	10%	+0.1%	-6%	-16%	yes	bull
01 Oct 2025	\$117,968	10%	+0.6%	-8%	-26%	yes	bull
13 Jan 2026	\$94,792	12%	+0.6%	-31%	-22%	yes	bear
16 Mar 2026	\$74,075	18%	+1.1%	-0%	-12%	yes	bear
17 Apr 2026	\$76,120	17%	+1.3%	+0%	-17%	yes	bear
21 Jul 2026	\$65,747	14%	+1.2%	+10%		yes	bear
20 Aug 2026	\$70,033	13%	+4.2%	+11%		no	bear
21 Sep 2026	\$82,281	10%	+5.2%				bear

The 21 September 2026 breakout is the last row and is not graded yet.

THE LIVE CASE

SEPTEMBER 2026, THE **TIGHTEST** RANGE OF THE YEAR

BREAKOUT	RANGE HIGH	RANGE WIDTH	CLOSE ABOVE	+30D	+90D	LOST LEVEL 30D	YEAR
13 Jan 2026	\$94,792	12%	+0.6%	-31%	-22%	yes	bear
16 Mar 2026	\$74,075	18%	+1.1%	-0%	-12%	yes	bear
17 Apr 2026	\$76,120	17%	+1.3%	+0%	-17%	yes	bear
21 Jul 2026	\$65,747	14%	+1.2%	+10%		yes	bear
20 Aug 2026	\$70,033	13%	+4.2%	+11%		no	bear
21 Sep 2026	\$82,281	10%	+5.2%				bear

Every range breakout of 2026.

Five range breakouts came before this one in 2026. January, March and April all lost the level inside a month and were 12% to 22% lower three months later, the bear-year pattern. July lost the level and still ran, and August held. The 21 September breakout came out of a range from \$74,913 to \$82,281, 9.8% wide, the tightest of the six, and closed 5.2% above it, the biggest push of the six. Two days later price was back near \$84,000.

THE READ

A retest of \$82,300 to \$83,100 is what most breakouts have done. It does not answer whether this one worked. The weekly close on Sunday 27 September above \$82,833 is the test this page has used all month. This is a study, not a call.

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

Thirteen bear-year breakouts. The regime split is the finding and the bear side of it is small. It describes a lean, not a law.

Regime is the calendar year. Crude, but it cannot be tuned after the fact. It also means the regime is only certain in hindsight, which is why this page uses a price line, \$82,833, as the live test.

The range is one definition. Thirty days and 25% wide. Different windows find different breakouts. The 15% version is printed on the rule page and gives the same answer.

The retest is not a trade. This study measures what breakouts did, not a strategy with entries, stops and costs. A retest that becomes a failed breakout looks identical to one that holds, on the day.

Data pinned 23 September 2026, 10:48am ET. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily bars, wicks for highs and lows. Scripts: Breakout/bo_study.py, bo_retest.py, bo_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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